BRIGHAM YOUNG
UNIVERSITY
IDAHO

ED 304: Educational Psychology

- **Class times: T/R 12:45-2:15 PM. HIN 171.**
- **Lab hours: Th/F 4-5 PM. HIN 307.**
    - **Other times by appointment**

Part I: Course Introduction and Organization

Instructor:
Benjamin Pacini **(**But, like, call me BroPa). pacinib@byui.edu*. 801.618.7865.** Zoom: 899.634.5818.

- Drop-In Hours: Th/F 4-5 PM. HIN 307.
- My office (come by anytime!) is in HIN 273.****

Course Motivation and Organization:
This course is motivated by four driving questions; these four questions also frame the course:

- Who are we, and who are we becoming?
    - Unit 1: Child and Human Development.
- How do we learn?
    - Unit 2: Cognition, Learning, and Educational Psychology.
- Why do we learn?
    - Unit 3: Motivation and Management.
- What does it take to be an excellent teacher, and a Christlike disciple in these times?
    - Unit 4: Crash Course: Research Methods and Clinical Psychology

Course Invitation:

Dear Students,

Welcome to Educational Psychology! This course is designed to introduce you to the study of how people learn and develop, and how these processes can be understood and applied in educational settings.

Throughout the semester, we will explore a variety of topics including cognitive and social-emotional development, learning theories, and more. You will have the opportunity to engage in hands-on activities, discussions, and projects that will help you better understand these concepts and how to apply them in your own practice.

I am excited to work with you and help you grow as learners and educators. I look forward to our time together and the opportunity to learn together.

Sincerely,

BroPa*******

*I'm a terrible texter. I'm mediocre at answering phones, but I'm decent w/email. Best of all is the zoom channel, which I'll show in class. BE SQUEAKY!
** Google voice is great because it has a great spam screen to keep out detestable vacuum salespeople. Say who you are, and it'll put you through.
***This is your first penguin. PENGUIN! (Still only counts as one.)
****Seriously, just come by. I'm off campus Wed/Fri, but other times I'm easy to find. I'll bring the memes, candy, and dad jokes. You bring you. I guess. Or… don't?
***** See here. The RickRoll is the highest form of humor. Fight me.
******My entire course invitation was written by a robot. Not joking. Thanks ChatGPT.

Part II: Standards and Outcomes

Course Vision

As a disciple of Christ, come have a collaborative experience that will help you apply sound principles of learning and human development. Your investment will edify your progress as a learner and teacher that will prepare you to honor how we learn both generally and uniquely throughout our lives.

Course Description

Relying heavily on social science, cognitive neuroscience, and the study of Christ as master teacher, this course is designed to explore child and adolescent development, to identify principles that promote understanding and guide the creation and implementation of purposeful and meaningful learning experiences, and to identify teaching strategies that promote thoughtfulness in both the affective and cognitive domains.

Course Outcomes:

- Recognize patterns of social, emotional, cognitive, and spiritual development in myself and others in order to uncover sound principles.
- Accept inspiration and apply sound principles of teaching and learning to myself and others and refine my process on an on-going basis.
- Create effective learning experiences based on the learner's individual developmental, social, emotional, and cognitive needs.
- Adopt the Christlike attributes, behaviors, and skills of teacher-researchers in maintaining and improving my knowledge of the field and teaching practices.

Part III: Course Breakdown and Grading:

Course Breakdown:

- **Waldorf Textbook**: I hate making students buy expensive textbooks that they never use–and besides, we learn by doing anyway. As such, I'm going to do something rather Waldorfian: in this class, you're going to be building your textbook as a major part of your coursework. Please note that using AI is encouraged (e.g. ChatGPT) but you must disclose that you have used it–and you are responsible for any mistakes the AI makes. Grading of Waldorf assignments is binary and mastery-based: you will get either full points or a zero, but if you submit on time you can resubmit as many times as you need to in order to get the score you need (as long as you're submitting your best work).
- **Readings and Reading Expectations**: Your readings will consist of the textbook that we are reading in this class, and any additional study that you feel you need in order to have a good understanding of all the concepts in the course. You should spend an average of roughly 90 minutes per week of reading, including note-taking. If you get to 120 minutes (two hours) you should stop and reach out to me. You should read for conversion, not for coverage; the purpose of this reading is to change the way you see the world, not to memorize facts or information. At the same time, you need to read and study enough that you can use the concepts involved. My recommendation is to begin by reading the textbook sections that are assigned for the week and take notes. Then, look up any minor concepts you don't understand and make flash cards with clear definitions. Then, do the same for moderate concepts, but with more explanation and application. Finally, do a deep dive on the major topics in the class. Again, if you are doing more than 90 minutes, that's more than you ought to be. Keep going to the full two hours, and then reach out to me and let me know. Remember to learn how to read *for learning* and not *for*

completion! Your job is to understand, not to tick the box that says "I read every word!" There are two ways I will assess your readings: assessment and reading checks.

- *Assessments*:This class has, as one of its common assessments, a major exam. As such, we will have daily quizzes in class for the purpose of practice, and unit tests after each three weeks of class. These assessments are built to ensure you're understanding the concepts in the class, and also that you're completing your reading.
- *Reading Checks*: Notes are a great way to help you remember the most important things you read. You are required to take notes on what you learn in your reading, and strongly encouraged to review your notes before bed each night and each morning for five minutes. You will submit your reading notes for each week's reading. The goal is to prove that you read, but also to summarize and synthesize what you learned. (You can do it in other forms too: video, audio, interpretive dance, go nuts.) You will also assign yourself a score which will be checked and verified by the TA. Grade yourself honestly, and if you have to choose, err on the side of being harsh. We really like to change grades upward rather than downward!

- **Contribution to Community**: Attendance is required–but not sufficient for–success in this class. In-class time accounts for fully one-third of the course expectations (given that you spend two hours outside of class for every hour inside of class) and so I am quite strict about attendance. Understand, however, that I do not merely want you there and on time but also fully participating: one of the most important parts of this class is modeling for you how important a strong community is. This includes attendance, but also positive contribution to class, which could include raising your hand, teaching each other, giving insightful comments, actively keeping the class discussion on track, submitting memes to the thread, capturing great quotes, or providing a bit of daily inspiration. (You will absolutely be asked to do fun, silly, joyful things just for the sake of making connections around here!) In terms of grades, here is the breakdown:
  - Attendance checks: Similar to reading checks, you'll upload notes (or interpretive dances, etc.,) grade your participation, and write a brief reflection of how you participated in class for each day of class.
  - Teaches: We become great teachers by teaching. You will teach once per week in this class, for roughly 10 minutes. Teaches are divided into 5-8 minutes of learning activities and another 2-5 of assessment. You will also have 2 minutes to get feedback from peers about your teach. Your assessment comes in four ways: you will score your own reflection in canvas (which must include a grade for your own work), your peers will grade you, the instructor and TA for the course will grade you, and you will be accountable for what you learn on the unit tests and final for the class. A note on peer reviews: I am the only one who gives the final score for the class. If your peers mark you down, they should tell you why. I will not use this to score you lower, but I will come and watch your teaches more carefully if I have a concern. I reserve the right to grade teach assignments directly if I feel that a student is grading themselves too easily or too harshly.
  - Surveys and Ratings: I am always hungry for feedback about my courses. You will be asked to give some feedback to me at midterm and end-of-semester.
  - Consultancy Project: You will be asked to complete a short project at the end of the course that makes you think like a consultant. The point of the project is "how would you have taught the course?" Make sure to include A) what you loved B) what you might have done differently and C) one big change you would make that would make the biggest difference.
- **Case Study and Experiential Learning**
  - One of the major forms of learning in this class is through the Connections Case Study. This will be a semester-long project broken into six parts that are due every two weeks. On the off weeks, I've designed

experiential learning experiences that should take you about an hour on average. These should expand your understanding of educational psychology.

- **Major Exams**
    - There will be unit exams for each unit in this class consisting of 20 questions each. Students will help create test items for the test, and test items will be used in class to help students prepare for the final. Tests may be taken as many times as needed in order to get the score you would like, with the exception of the final exam. If you score higher on the final exam than you have in the course, I will take the higher of the two grades, with the exception of students who have missed too much class.
- Notice on time constraints and efficiency:
    - One of the skills of a highly effective teacher (that is, the kind that you will need in order to be successful as a teacher) is the ability to get things done efficiently. This class is a lot of work, and is designed that way on purpose. You should not spend four hours per week on reading, nor should you spend eight hours on the case study near the end of the semester (rather, you should do the case study throughout the semester!) Learn how to get things done efficiently and reach out early if you have concerns.

Attendance Note:
Attendance is necessary for success in this class. I encourage students to attempt to get a perfect score for attendance in this class.

- Any student who misses more than six days of class will automatically have to retake the course.
- Students can miss two days of class for any reason (I encourage you to try not to use these, however, if you can).
- Students who miss more than two days will take a minor hit to their attendance for absence three and four.
- Students who miss more than four days will take a grade drop of a full letter grade for each day missed.
- While I'm happy to excuse extenuating circumstances, the following rules apply:
    - You already have two days built in. Use them wisely.
    - I will only excuse a maximum of four total days, even in the case of emergency.
    - Don't just participate, bring light and joy to the class.

Questions and Communication
In the first week of class, you will learn about our zoom channel: please check it daily. (You can check on any non-chromebook computer, or any smartphone.) While I'm always happy to answer questions, please do all you can to ask peers and consult class materials (e.g. syllabus) before reaching out. Questions that may apply to the whole class can be asked in the Zoom chat; personal questions should be emailed. I encourage people to ask their group first, the zoom channel second, the TA third, and BroPa fourth--to build your capacity to answer your own questions. That said, just ask! I love interacting with students, and will happily answer even if you go out of order.

The next line contains invisible text. Highlight with your cursor to see what it says.

Grading:
Please reference the University's grading explanation here. Letter Grades are assigned according to the following scale:

A	93-100	A-	90-93	B+	87-89	B	83-86
B-	80-82	C+	77-79	C	73-76	C-	70-73
D+	67-69	D	63-66	D-	60-62	F	0-59

Grade Breakdown:

- 15% Waldorf Build-a-Book
- 15% Experiential Learning and Connections Case Study

- 30% Contribution to community (10% each: attendance, teaches, readings)
- 40% Exams (5% for each unit exam, 20% for the final).

Part IV: Course Expectations and Explanations:

Required Texts:

- **I don't care what the booklist says,** I'm not making you buy some $400 book.
- You will only need the following (but you really will need these):
    - A full sheet of white cardstock paper (to use as a name plate).
    - A rubik's cube.
    - A sheet protector, dry erase marker, and piece of fabric (a sock is fine, if clean).
    - A working computer, headphones/mic, an internet connection, and access to email.
    - The link to the course textbook (which will be empty at the beginning of the semester!)
    - Access to the zoom channel (I'll show you in class!)

Optional/Recommended Reading:

There are many free resources online, including Open Educational Resources (OER) that are effectively free textbooks. We will use some of these in class:

- https://edpsych.pressbooks.sunycreate.cloud/part/using-science-to-inform-educational-practices/
- http://home.cc.umanitoba.ca/~seifert/EdPsy2009.pdf
- https://instr.iastate.libguides.com/oer/psychology
- https://www.bncoerplus.com/course/welcome-to-educational-psychology/#1534237108247-c47bdb94-352e

A Note on Artificial Intelligence:

- I ***strongly encourage*** the use of artificial intelligence (AI) during this course, on the condition that you use it ethically and transparently. You may use AI (such as https://chat.openai.com/chat) so long as you use it as directed to (for example, to help you write textbook chapters and not to cheat on tests) and so long as you do so transparently (that is, you fully disclose any time you use the service).

Course Policies and Procedures:

Statement on dress code and honor code:

I have worked in schools that have no honor code, and it makes me pretty grateful to be here. I'm a pretty big fan. I hope you are too. Do I care about little tiny rules? Not really, no. But I care a great deal about integrity–yes, even in the little things.

And while I'm only a little evil, I am evil. I am a former middle school teacher, and assistant principal. Be wise. Be kind to yourself, and keep the rules without being asked. Be kind to me by not making me have an awkward conversation. My background is such that I will say something. Keep your promises. If you have an issue with anything, bring it up *before* you break it. I'm pretty easy to talk to about these things. Keep in mind that the honor code is a lot more than just dress and grooming–so let's do both. We'll discuss this more in class.

On Tuesdays, you're encouraged to dress up a little for devotional. I think you'd be surprised to see what a difference it can make. Also, come looking fancy on days when you are teaching. Remember "dress down" days? "Dress up" instead.

Mastery-Based Learning and Late Work

This class functions in the paradigm of Mastery-based learning, originally conceived of by Benjamin Bloom. It's good stuff, and you should look it up. (Here's a thing I wrote on it if you need a life.) What this means for you is that you may keep submitting work to get the grade you desire so long as you meet the following two criteria:

1) You submit the work early (or on time)
2) You submit work that is clearly your best effort.

Late work will not be penalized, but will only be graded once. Typically it will be graded by me rather than the TAs (and I tend to be a little harsher than they are). You will not have a chance to resubmit for improved grades if you submit late. All assignments can be submitted late with no penalty, with the exception of missing too much class to pass the course.

Zeroes
Mastery-based learning is great because it allows you to resubmit: that means that you can keep working at it until you understand the assignment. It also allows me to set a high bar for coursework. As such, most work in my class is graded pass/fail: you either get an A or a 0. If you have a 0 in your gradebook, you should interpret it as "an assignment I haven't quite got down yet." You will get more zeroes than you are used to. Don't stress. Keep at it. Take the feedback and resubmit. Talk to me if you need.

Peer Grading
You will give tons of peer feedback. You are about to be teachers, so this is good training. I expect you to grade with **kindness, honesty, and care**. While you will give suggested grades, I am ultimately responsible for grades in this course.

Teaches cannot be made up outside of meeting with me. If you know you will miss a teach, try to swap with another teammate early. If you wake up sick, contact me to find a way to make up the teach. Please be mature and professional about extenuating circumstances. (*cough* family-vacations-aren't-emergencies *cough*) You will find me to be very understanding, if you are very responsible.

Submitting Links
Links will be shared correctly, or your photo will go on the "I-don't-know-how-to-share-links-the-right-way" wall-of-shame.

Note on Emotional Health
I believe strongly that creating emotionally strong, resilient students is about both decreasing stress, and increasing capacity. If discussions of emotional health are sensitive or difficult for you, please let me know as early as possible. I do not claim to have all the right ideas on this, but feel it to be important enough to bring up and discuss.

Additionally, I suspect that many of you lean toward perfectionism: teaching will help with that. You will learn, quickly, the art of "good enough." You should never feel the need to spend 3 hours on a 1 hour assignment. Be wise. Learn how to manage your own time carefully. Learn that excellence is better than perfectionism (including in grades) and know the difference between integrity and scrupulosity.

A thought on emotional health and grades: I hope all of you are aiming for an A. But I hope you realize that the real goal isn't the A, it's the learning--it's the success that you'll have in your classroom someday because of what you learned, the students' lives who will be changed, and the relationships you'll build with teachers, parents, students, and communities--and most importantly, the Lord. This is a very long-term game. You will see your success measured not in months, or even years, but decades and generations.

Syllabus Changes
This syllabus is a guide and every attempt is made to provide an accurate overview of the course. I will always let you know as soon as a change to the syllabus is in the works.

Sensitive Topics, Bias, and Purpose
I do not believe that it is in your best interest for me to avoid difficult conversations. To the contrary, learning how to wrestle with difficult topics is one of the most important things you can take from your BYU-Idaho education. An education that doesn't address the hard issues is one that isn't worth paying for. I hope that I am able to raise difficult, sensitive, challenging issues–and consistently push your thinking, even if I can't resolve them perfectly. As such, some notes:

- You're paying for me to challenge your thinking. I hope to shoot down bad ideas! At the same time, feel free to push back, so long as you are polite, civil, and articulate. Be polite and civil and articulate, but the point of the class is to learn to challenge each other in healthy ways. You will need to be ready for the push, though!
- This class touches directly on sensitive topics like psychology of gender, family structure, and plenty more. I'm not doing you a favor if I skip the sensitive stuff. If there are topics that you are sensitive about, feel free to come let me know privately. I'll do what I can to talk about these things thoughtfully, but I feel the obligation to talk through them.
- I have a point of view: I'm pretty heavily biased in the direction of what the research seems to say, for example, and I'm a believing Latter-day Saint. Sometimes viewpoint neutrality is the right course, sometimes it's important to be clear about what I believe.
- It's impossible to fully get rid of all your biases. I'll try to focus on presenting both sides of an argument when appropriate, but if I can't, I'll try to lay out my reasoning and be transparent. My intent is not to make you *think like me* but it is to *make you think.*
- Elder Paul V. Johnson has asked faculty to have both "moral courage" and "intellectual courage." That means that I'm going to stand up for things I believe in. More importantly, I'm going to encourage you to do likewise.

On social media and my writings:
You are welcome to follow me on social media, but you are never going to be required to. You should understand that I have opinions on things, including politics, and that we may not agree. If you are willing to be my friend, I'll be happy to add you–but I will not give any brownie points or extra credit for it.

I also have a podcast and write occasionally in various places. If you would like to listen to my podcast, please click here. (Also, and I say this with love, get a life.)

A couple of the pieces I have published may be relevant to my classes, however, so I have included them below. They are my opinion only.

You Belong in My Classroom: This article is an explanation of how important it is to create a safe place of belonging in my classroom, and also why I don't use pride imagery. It isn't perfect, but it may give you insight into how I feel about things. (This is the second draft of an article that first appeared at Public Square Magazine.)

The Case for Heroic Masculinity: this is an article on the topic of toxic masculinity, and its opposite, heroic masculinity. My basic point is simple: we need good men, not just non-toxic men. And the way we get there is through story-telling.

Part V: Standard Disclosures

Academic Honesty
"When you are honest in every way, you are able to enjoy peace of mind and maintain self-respect. You build strength of character, which allows you to be of service to God and others. You are trustworthy in the eyes of God and those around you. If you are dishonest in your words or actions, you hurt yourself and often hurt others as well. If you lie, steal, cheat, or neglect to give the full amount of work for your pay, you lose your self-respect. You lose the guidance of the Holy Ghost" ("Honesty," True to the Faith (2004), 84)

Academic Honesty means students do their own work. This also means their instructors will evaluate that work. Students should not be dishonest—this includes all types of work in their courses. The complete Academic Honesty Policy can be found here. Penguin. I'm evil, lol. Who puts a penguin in the standard disclosures? That's like supervillain level evil.

All students attending BYU-Idaho have agreed in writing to adhere to the Honor Code. Cheating, which includes plagiarism, will not be tolerated. This includes using materials you did not create and claiming them as your own. Using ideas and resources shared in the teaching community is supported, however you must give attribution and add your own ideas, experience, etc. to found resources. Please check with the instructor before using resources such as Teachers Pay

Teachers and Influencer produced materials. Anyone caught cheating will receive a zero on the assignment or exam, will be reported to the Student Honor Office, and may be expelled from the course.

Academic Support
Go to http://www.byui.edu/AcademicSupport , or come to the McKay Library 272 for information about how the writing, reading, math, and study skills centers can help you increase your success in all of your classes. To schedule a tutor for a specific class, log on to the Academic Support website, click on Tutor Request under Student Services and follow the instructions.

Academic Grievances
Students are encouraged to contact their instructors regarding course-related concerns. If concerns cannot be resolved in this way, students may contact the BYU-Idaho Support Center to formally register a concern or grievance.

Disability Services
BYU-Idaho does not discriminate against persons with disabilities in providing its educational and administrative services and programs and follows applicable federal and state law. This policy extends to the University's electronic and information technologies (EIT).

Students with qualifying disabilities should contact the Disability Services Office at disabilityservices@byui.edu or 208.496.9210. Additional information about Disability Services resources can be found at http://www.byui.edu/disabilities

I am very easy to work with on this. Please know, however, that the best thing I can do for any student is give them resources, empower them, and hold them to a high bar. Talk with me early if I can help in any way. PENGUIN.

Preventing Sexual Misconduct
BYU-Idaho prohibits sex discrimination by its employees and students in all of its education programs or activities. This includes all forms of sexual harassment, such as sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence, stalking, conditioning a grade or job on participation in sexual conduct, and other forms of unwelcome sexual conduct.

As an instructor, one of my responsibilities is to help create a safe learning environment for my students and for the campus as a whole. University policy requires deans and department chairs, and encourages all faculty, to report every incident of sexual harassment that comes to their attention. If you encounter or experience sexual harassment, please contact the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@byui.edu or 208-496-9209. Additional information about sex discrimination, sexual harassment, and available resources can be found at www.byui.edu/titleix.

This space left intentionally blank